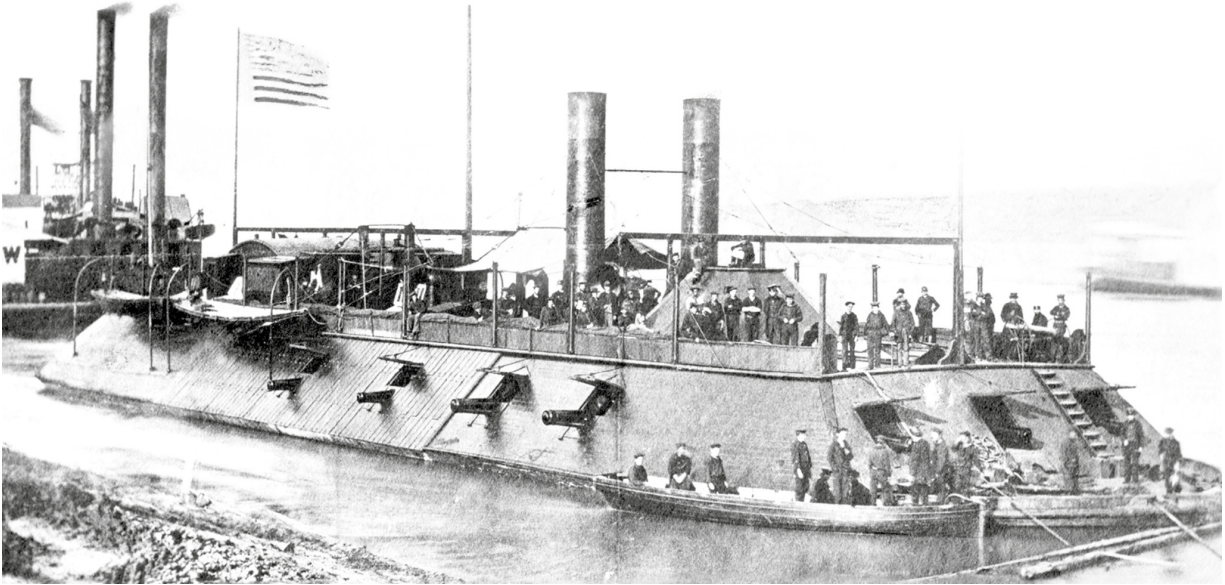




### The "Pook Turtle"

USS *Cairo* was one of the Union City-class ironclad gunboats designed by Samuel Pook for the river war. Commissioned in January 1862, she initially had 16 guns and a crew of 250.

“... they **struck terror** into every guilty soul as they **floated down the river.**”

CREW MEMBER OF A POOK TURTLE, 1862

### Island Number Ten

The first strongpoint that Union forces needed to overcome as they pressed down the Mississippi was Island Number Ten, a fortified position at a turn in the river near the town of New Madrid. At the start of March 1862, Major General John Pope's newly formed Army of the Mississippi, advancing through Missouri, arrived outside New Madrid. Unable to resist Union siege guns, the Confederates quickly abandoned the town, but the island was a tougher obstacle. The Union river flotilla arrived with its seven ironclads plus a group of mortar schooners, but their guns failed to have a decisive impact on the island's defenses. Pope's solution was